MIA XR COLLECTIVE PITCH · ROME · 22 OCTOBER 2026

Old Stories, New Doors

What five winters of *A Christmas Carol VR* taught us about classic IP

Alex Coulombe
CEO, Agile Lens: Immersive Design



YOUR SPEAKER

Alex Coulombe

Founder & CEO, Agile Lens: Immersive Design

Architect turned XR-chitect who has spent the last decade building spatial experiences for the world's most ambitious clients.

Authorized Unreal Engine instructor since 2020: 300+ classes taught, 40+ courses written.

16	10	10	100+
YEARS IN XR	YEARS OF AGILE LENS	YEARS IN UNREAL	EXPERIENCES BUILT

ROYAL SHAKESPEARE COMPANY

CBS

FOUR SEASONS

ARLEKIN PLAYERS

WALDORF ASTORIA

AGILE LENS

IMMERSIVE DESIGN STUDIO

EST. 2016

NYC

LINCOLN CENTER

KENNEDY CENTER

FISHER DACHS ASSOCIATES

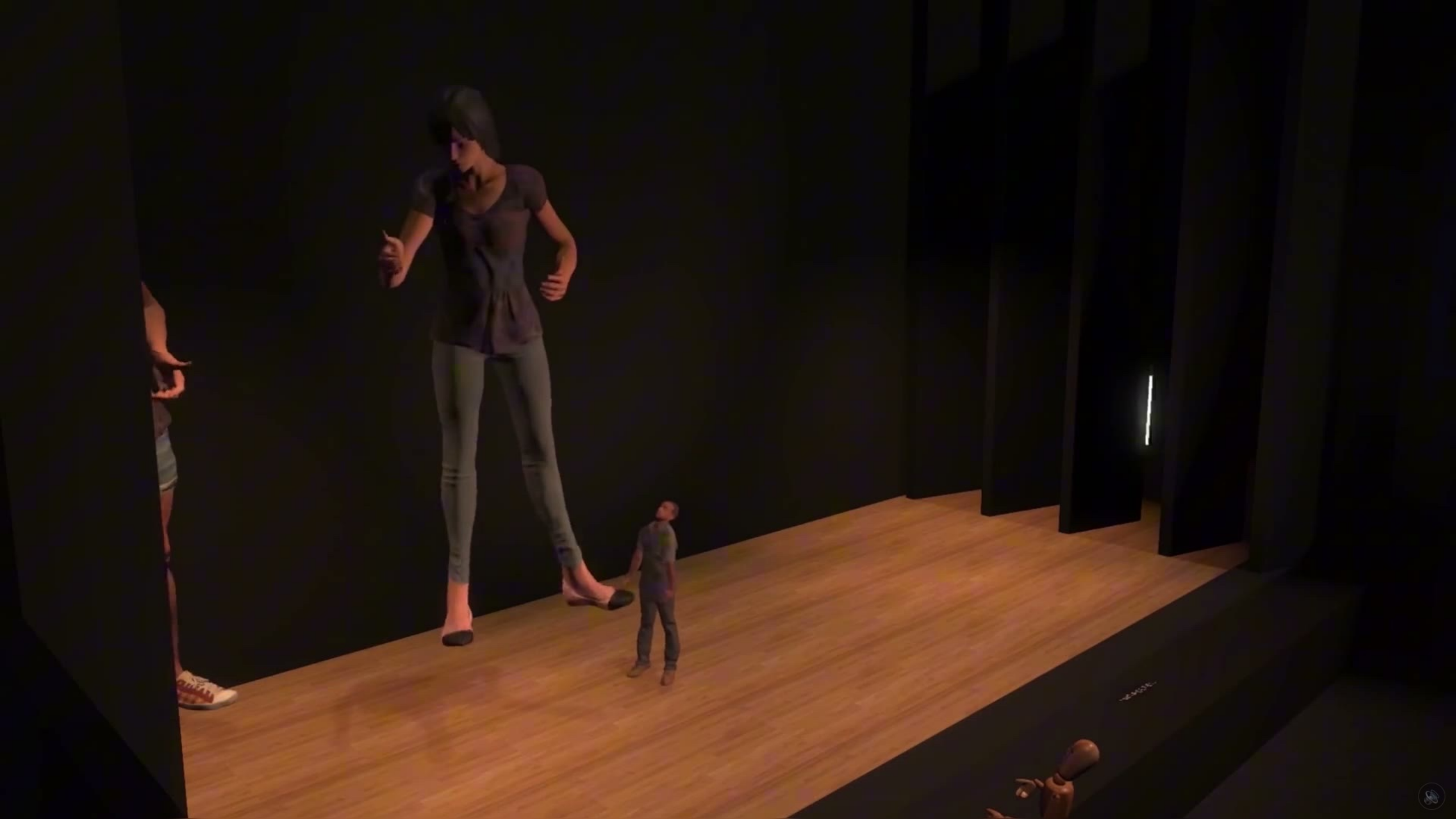
ACTORS THEATRE OF LOUISVILLE

SAMSUNG

DELL

ROYAL CARIBBEAN

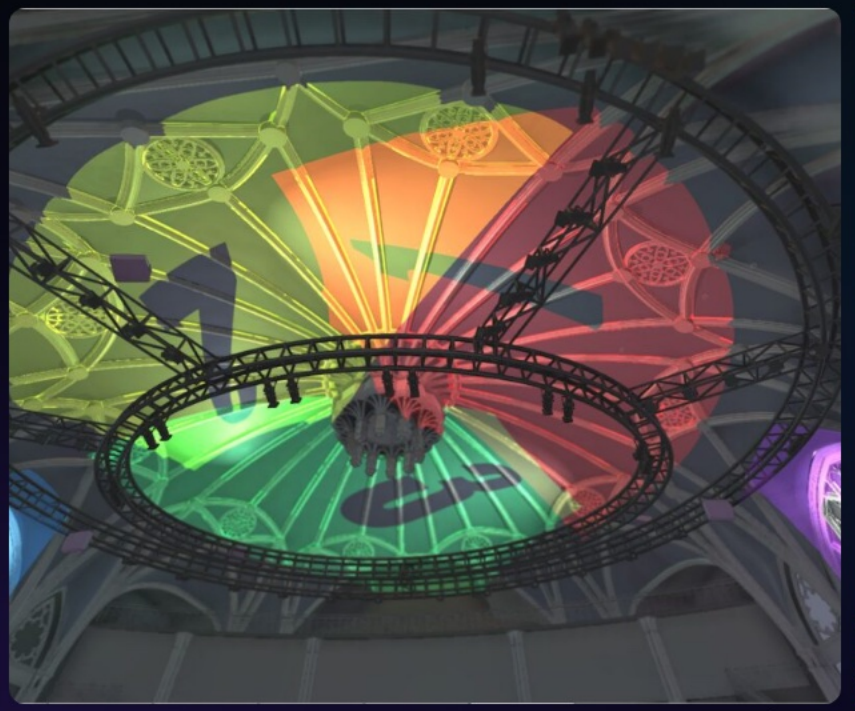
BOOTSTRAPPED · XR SPECIALISTS · 10 YEARS



















Tech Prototypes · Social Impact Architecture · Real Estate Training · Theatre

Client work funds the play.

But it all comes back to theatre...



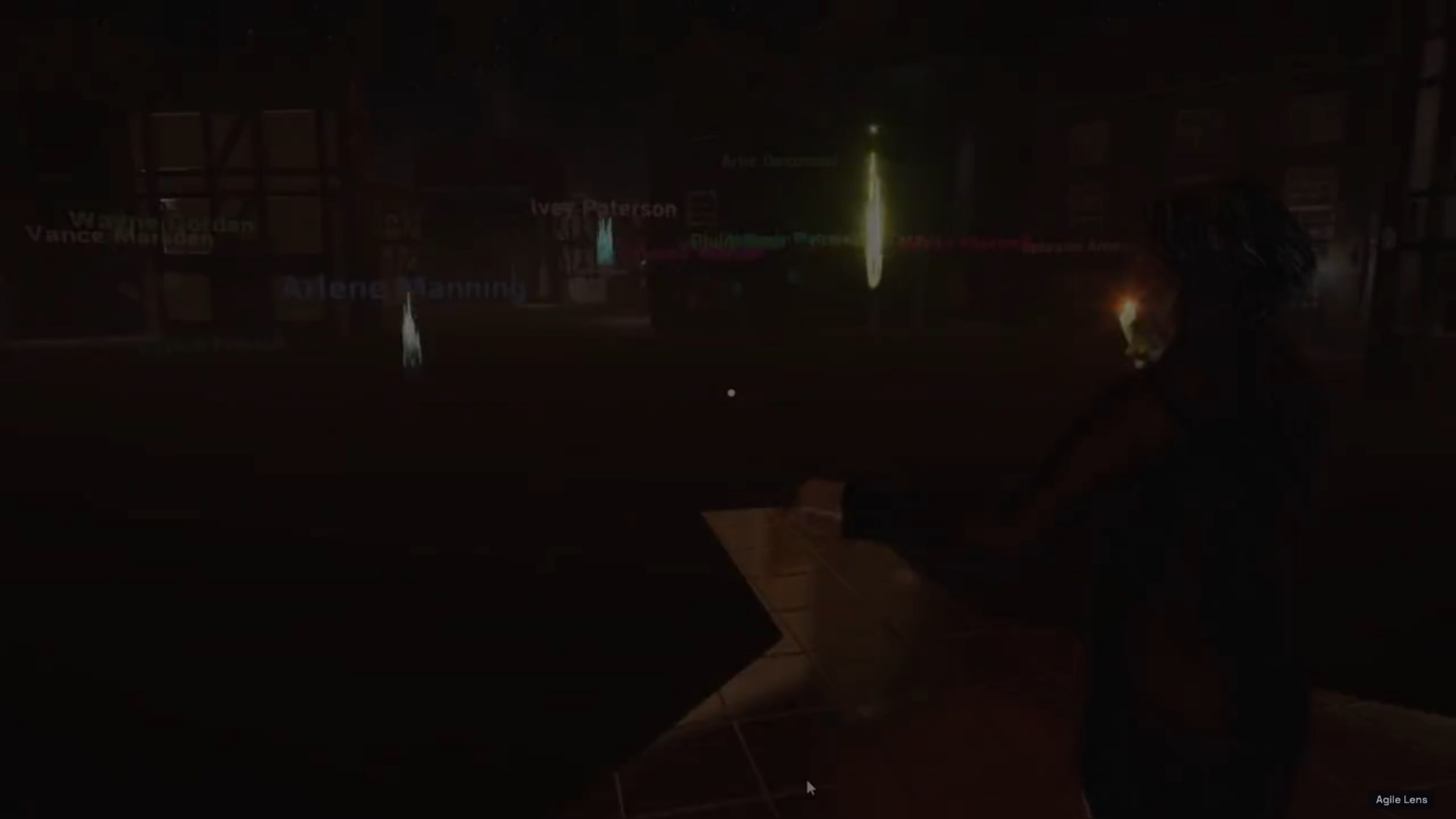


Theatre of the Oppressed workshop led by Julian Boal — © 2018 Richard Finkelstein








Ivey Paterson
Arlene Manning
Agile Lens

ACT II · 2 / 4

A Christmas Carol VR

YEARS 1–5 · TECH · AUDIENCE · ACTORS

A Christmas Carol VR · Five Seasons of Iteration

LIVE ACTOR → UNREAL ENGINE → AUDIENCES IN VR

	Year 1 2021 UE 4.27	Year 2 2022 UE 4.27	Year 3 2023 UE 5.2	Year 4 2024 UE 5.4 (Meta fork)	Year 5 2025 UE 5.4 (Meta fork)
TECH STACK	• MetaHumans (debut) • NVIDIA CloudXR • CoreWeave RTX A6000 • Audio: separate stream	• Optimized MetaHumans • Audio: Agora + Vivox • Manual cue board	• Standalone Quest build • Audio: Odin • OSC cue routing	• Modular cue system • LINE! integration • Mocap replication system	• Stage Presence toolkit • Unreal Engine Replay • Heavenue Cloud Editor
PERFORMANCE	• Solo actor (Ari Tarr) • Part live, part recorded • All ghosts pre-recorded • Xsens + Manus gloves • LiveLink Face	• Two actors • Live Dickens / Scrooge • Ghosts: face capture only • Body still pre-recorded	• Fully live performance • Actor alternates Dickens / Scrooge • Other actor: all ghosts (live) • Rokoko Smartsuit + gloves	• Meta Movement SDK • Quest Pro face capture • More interaction beats	• Refined two-actor pipeline • Actor–audience eye contact • YouTube livestreams
AUDIENCE	• Quest → cloud PCVR • Sprite avatars (by IP) • Passive, free flight • Confined to one room	• Spectator Ball • Better onboarding • Extended runtime	• Promenade movement • Dickens Home lobby • Audience can roam	• Audience name tags • AI Dickens — InworldAI • Desktop user messaging	• AI Dickens — ConvAI bust • Q&A with actors post-show • 150+ shows performed

From the FMX 2026 deck · Agile Lens



ACT II · CHRISTMAS CAROL

How Audiences Experienced It

Not watching a story. Standing inside one.

- Eye contact: the actor sees you, and plays the scene to you
- AI Dickens, a digital host voiced with the lead actor's permission, welcomes guests before curtain
- After the show, a live Q&A with the actors

And the reaction of
an appreciative audience.

Scott Stein @scottstein.bsky.social · 1h
I'm glad I dropped in to see this!

> **Alex Coulombe** @ibrews.bsky.social · 4h
> That's a wrap on #AChristmasCarolVR ! Thanks to the tiny but mighty team who made this happen & wonderful audience members (like

eminus @eminus.bsky.social · 58m
I was lucky enough to attend the final live performance of A Christmas Carol in VR today. Fantastic mix of technology and talented actors to bring Dickens and his classic tale to life!

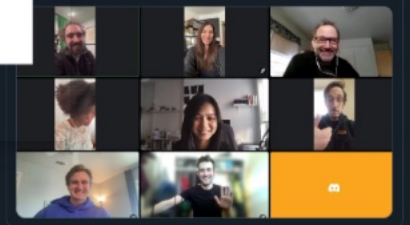
> **Alex Coulombe** @ibrews.bsky.social · 6h
> Wow!! What a lovely set of posts & excellent breakdown of the show
>
> We have our final performance of the year in less than 3 hours and it's technically sold out, but just for you cool kids on Bluesky I'll let you in on a little secret:
> you can download the app and join anyway!

Stephen Butchko · 1st
Founder member of Ferryman Collective, award winning producer, direc...
3w

Congratulations to Agile Lens: Immersive Design, Alex Coulombe, Kevin Laibson, Ari T. & Debbie Deer for another further evolved season of #ChristmasCarolVR. Deirdre V. Lyons & and I have been to every season and it is exciting to see the evolution of this classic tale. The world is very stable and more dynamic than ever and Debbie and Ari's performance cannot be beat. I encourage ya'll to sign up and check out what these pioneering folks are doing with #LiveTheatre in #VR.

Naïlo they/them @lucidvirtuality.bsky.social · 3h
#ChristmasCarolVR was fun, I'm glad I attended

> **Alex Coulombe** @ibrews.bsky.social · 4h
> That's a wrap on #AChristmasCarolVR ! Thanks to the tiny but mighty team who made this happen & wonderful audience members (like @eminus.bsky.social & @elizabethtasker.bsky.social) who came to support us.
>
> Here's most of us having our after-show recap and final goodbye. Happy holidays everyone!!



1 · 1 · 1

Alex Coulombe @ibrews.bsky.social · 2h
Thank you so much for attending Claren !

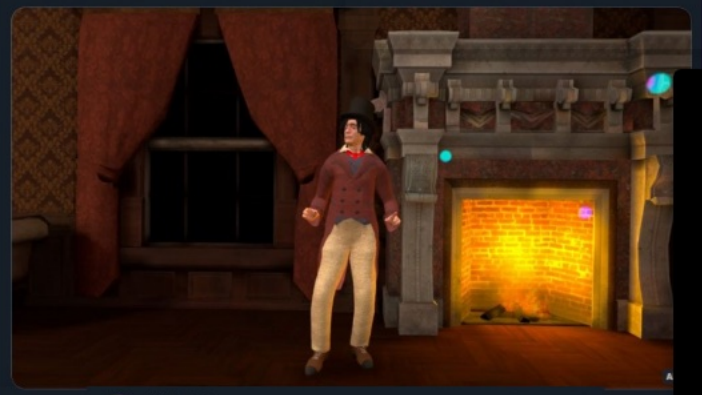
1 · 1

Claren Naïlo they/them
@lucidvirtuality.bsky.social
Thanks for putting on the show, Alex! It was fascinating to see the affordances of VR used in this way. I'd love to see more VR plays done like this

December 22, 2024 at 8:46 PM

Elizabeth Tasker
@elizabethtasker.bsky.social

This morning, I saw #AChristmasCarolVR, which was a live production of the Dickens classic in VR! Social VR experiences (for me) have the excitement of computer games in the 1980s: the technology is accessible enough to reach a wide audience, and the limitations are a driver for a ton of innovation



December

Nick Suda
@cloudcanvas.bsky.social
Following

Quite enjoyed catching the opening night of this. The world needs more live VR performances! Here's a random assortment of clips I grabbed while watching. #VRTheater #LiveVR #ChristmasCarol #AgileLens #CharlesDickens



Robert Copelan
@rcopelan

WOW doesn't even come close to describing what I just experienced! Was using a Quest 2. Next year I will ask our company's XR team to watch this. Congrats to your entire team. I haven't enjoyed "A Christmas Carol" this much in years.

Elizabeth Tasker
@elizabethtasker.bsky.social

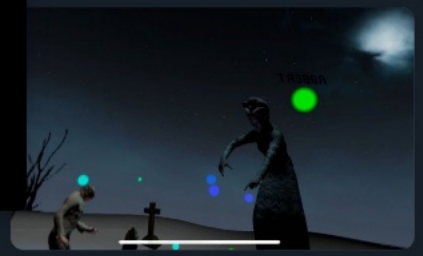
#NorahNeko and I are now ready for Christmas! And yes, I may have watched #AChristmasCarolVR in Christmas pudding PJs.



December 22, 2024 at 1:59 AM

beaker | b34k3r
@b34k3r.bsky.social

'hat amazing VR live performances in A hristmas Carol. I was able to join the last ow yesterday. Blown away at how good is was. Thanks to everyone involved. agilelens.bsky.social @ibrews.bsky.social



December 23, 2024 at 4:02 AM Everybody can reply

Jennifer Rei Kasuga Cameron · 1st
Founder of Maker Comet, where we pioneer creative experiences and en...
3w

If you've never been to a theater performance in VR, you definitely should! This unique medium takes traditional theater and enhances it in ways that make it more of an interactive experience rather than simply an audience watching passively. I look forward to seeing how this medium evolves! There are still showings available and you don't need a headset to experience the magic. Thanks, Alex Coulombe, Agile Lens: Immersive Design, and your talented cast for an inspiring performance today!

SwaMusic 12/23/2023 11:06 PM
Thank youuuu! Merry Christmasss and Happy New Yearrr!!
8

ZigZagMLT 12/23/2023 11:07 PM
Very impressive! Thank you so much for the opportunity to witness this live! Bravo to the whole team and to Ari and Debbie for excellent performances. This is a peek into the future right now.

ZIM VR Live
@Zimtok5

@xractor Killed it tonight. Not a blip.

The second half really gripped my wife and I, so a big thanks for the invitation and the tip so we could come along!

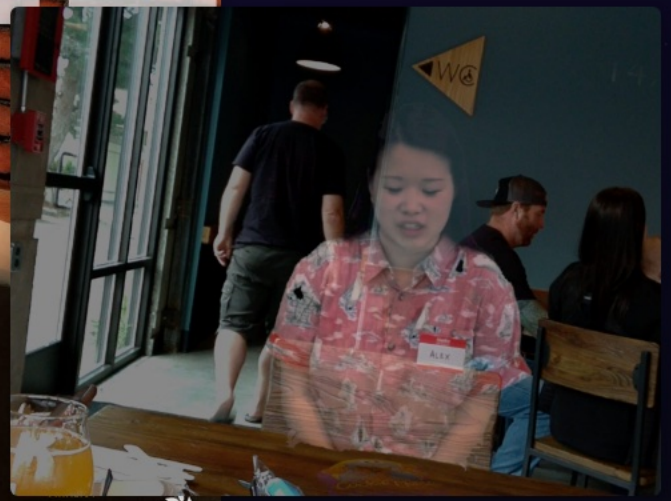
Ian XR Nerd 12/21/24, 3:13 PM
Just tried the Christmas Carol VR experience and that was fun. Thanks for putting it together and Happy holiday's!








GHOSTED
CANNES XR
DEVELOPMENT
SHOWCASE
KALEIDOSCOPE




make a gif.com





One Performance, Four Lives

Click a stop, or drag the playhead



DECEMBER 2025

Live in VR

Actors and audience together: 15 performances



EVERY SHOW

Recorded as data

Motion capture, cues and spatial audio. Not video.



AFTER THE RUN

Replayed and reshot

Any seat in the house; new camera coverage



DECEMBER 2026

Joined together

Attendees join the replay from headsets. Dates TBA.

Live — Recorded — Reshot — Together again

Video village

[FILL: Carol video village slide]




00:35:24:31 • iBrews_iPhone • 2778x1284
18 mm 16:9 Digital Film 1.778
19:10:01:13 24fps
Say something
Send Message
Talk to Dickens

ACT III · 3 / 4

Two Ways XR Works for Film.

Inside the pipeline: result is still a standard film.

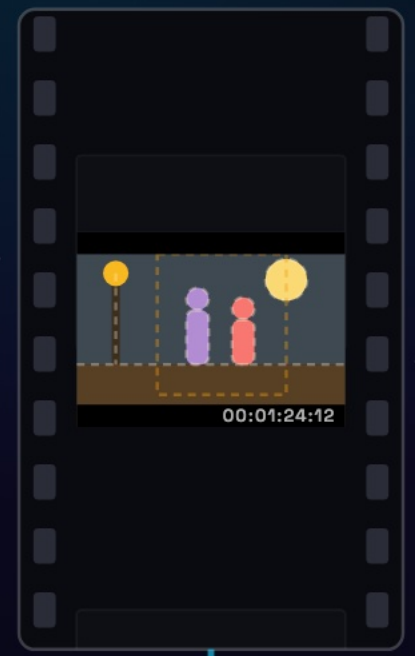
New product: adaptation that enhances audience.

XR Inside a Normal Film Pipeline

The crew uses the headset. The audience gets a normal film.



PRE-PRODUCTION	PRODUCTION	POST-PRODUCTION
Scout a scanned location in VR	Rehearse actors in the virtual set	Shoot new coverage from recordings
Try lenses, lights and blocking at 1:1	Capture performance onto digital humans	Reframe with a virtual camera
Pull stills into the shot list	Real-time previs and virtual sets	Review in VR, like dailies



XR for the crew

● Agile Lens has built this

A normal film. Any screen.

What the Crew Sees

Click a phase. None of this ends up on screen.

Pre-production | Production | Post-production



- Shoot new coverage from a recording
- Reframe with a virtual camera
- Review it like dailies

Agile Lens: A Christmas Carol VR replay and cinematographer builds

Cut Your Own Version of the Show

At our table today: a prototype built overnight for MIA



THE RECORDING

The full show, recorded

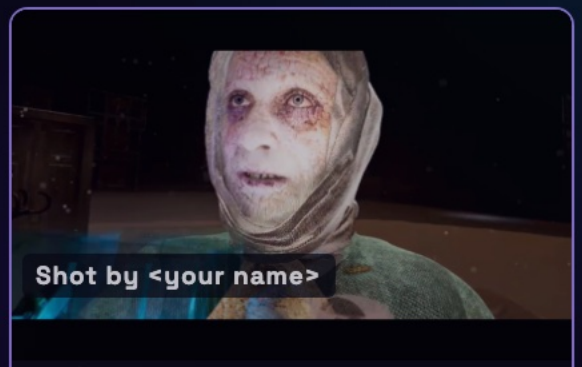
Laptop and gamepad, offline. Default scene: Dickens and Scrooge



YOU

You are the camera operator

Fly a virtual camera through the performance; 24, 35, 50 or 85 mm



YOUR SHOT

Your shot, credited

Add or replace a shot anywhere in the show



A NEW CUT

A new cut of the whole show

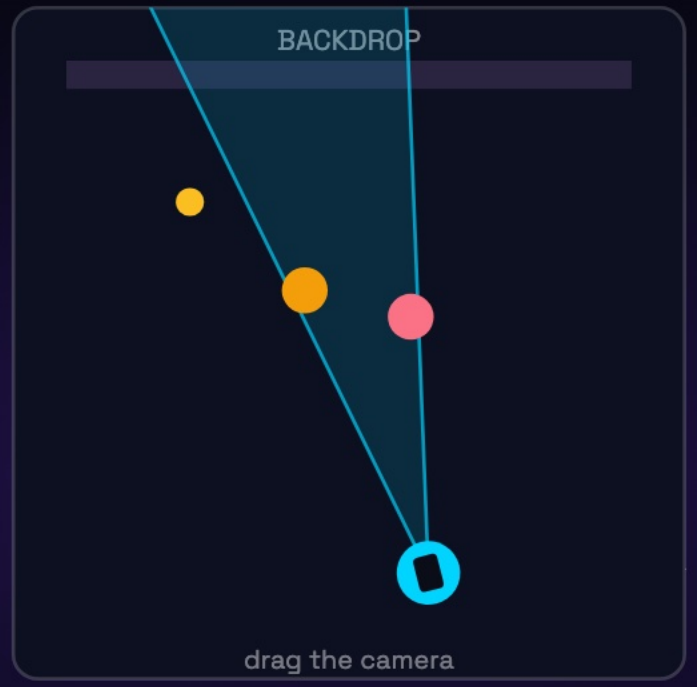
Plays back in 2.39 with a WORKING CUT title card; survives a crash; exports

Recorded show — Your camera — Credited — Working cut

Find the Shot Before You Fly

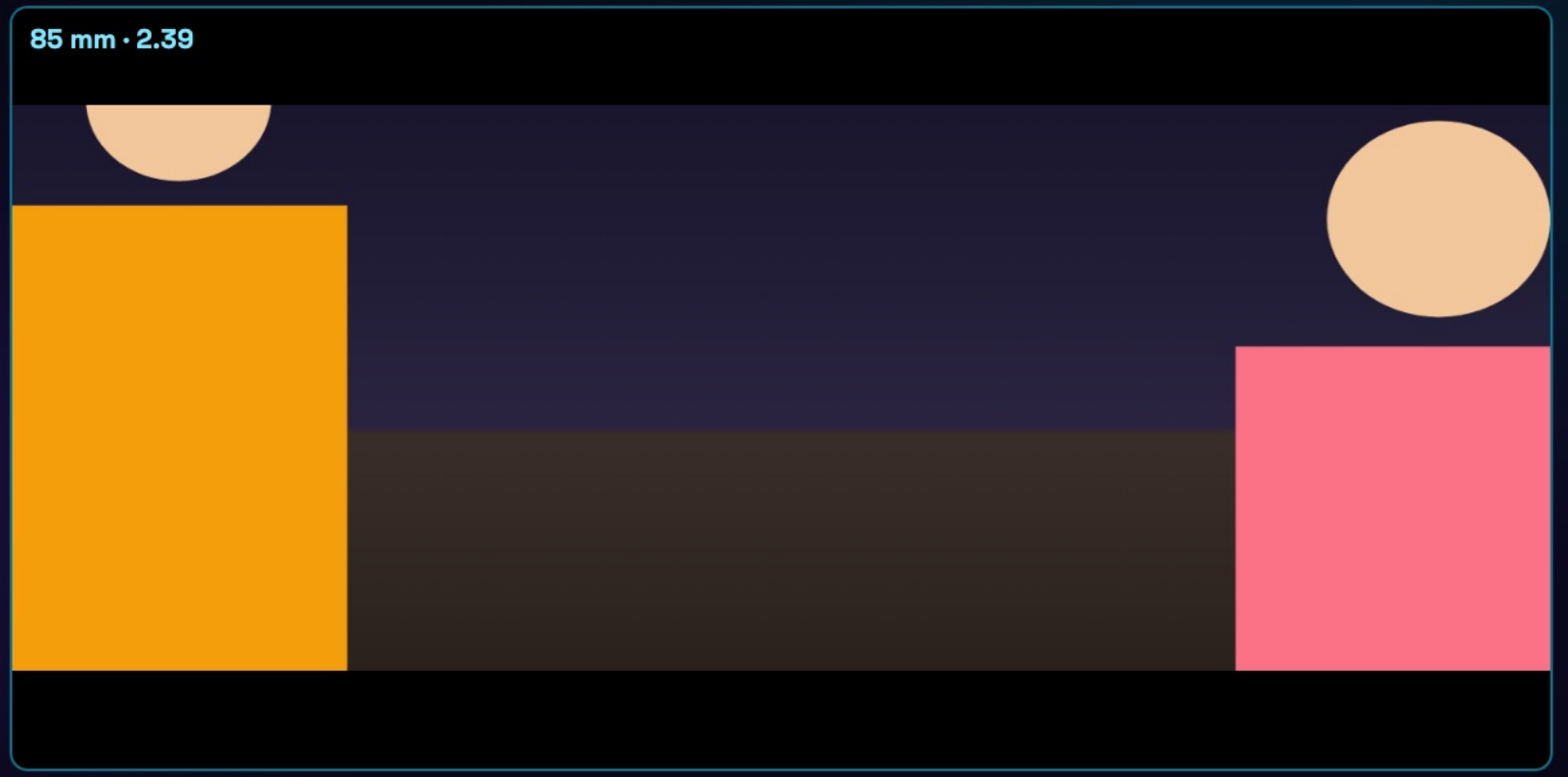
Drag the camera. Pick a lens. Take the shot.

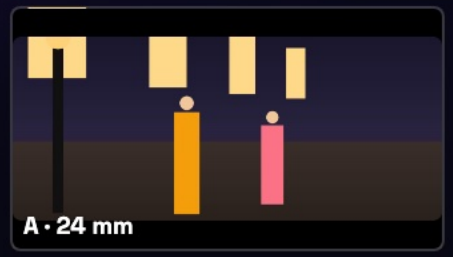
CONCEPT DEMO, BUILT FOR THIS TALK

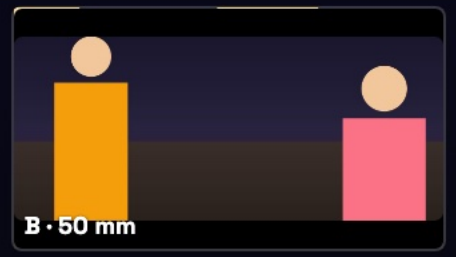


24 mm | 35 mm | 50 mm | 85 mm

2.39 mask | Take shot











Scan the Real Place. Walk It Before You Fly.

Gaussian splats: a photoreal capture of a real location you can stand in

- Capture a real place in minutes, with a phone or a scanner
- Photoreal, view-dependent detail at human scale
- Walk it in VR at 1:1: scout, block, try lenses, plan shots
- Share the space with a remote director, DP or producer
- Reuse it as a virtual-production backdrop or set extension
- Lighter than a photoreal mesh; cheap to re-scan when the place changes

● Agile Lens has done this ○ What a splat can do


XGRIDS
Captured by
Josette Seitz
MILANO CORTINA
2026

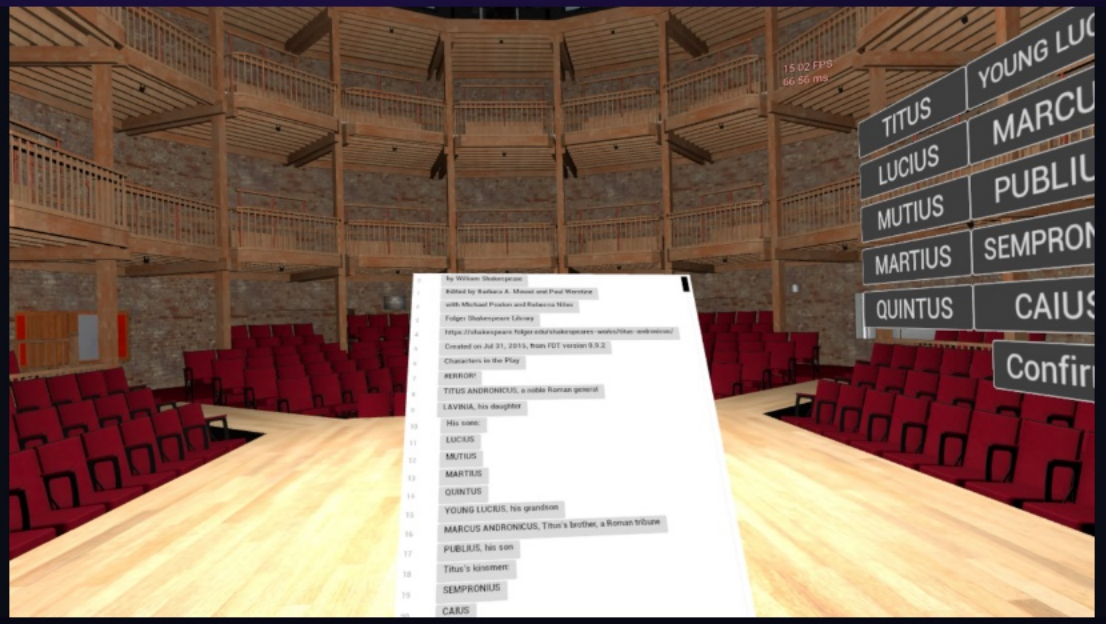
Same Rehearsal, Two Rooms

Drag the line

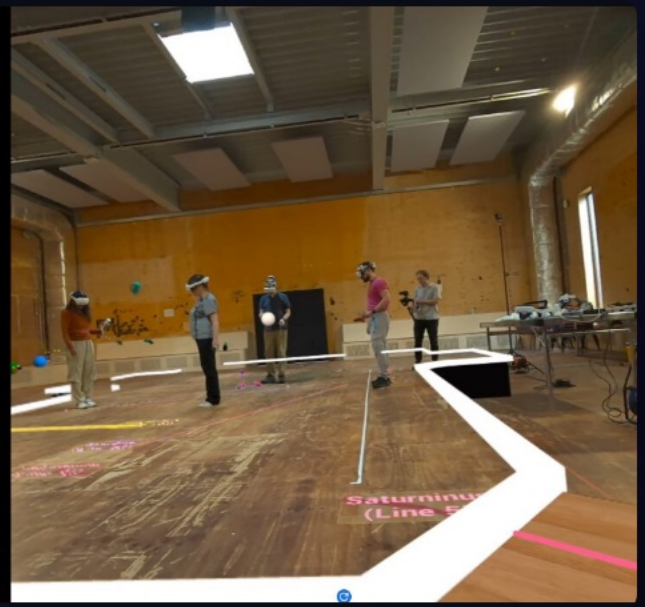







TITUS
YOUNG LUC
LUCIUS
MARCU
MUTIUS
PUBLIU
MARTIUS
SEMPRON
QUINTUS
CAIUS
Confir
15.02 FPS
66.56 ms
by William Shakespeare
Edited by Barbara A. Mowat and Paul Werstine
with Michael Poston and Rebecca Niles
Folger Shakespeare Library
https://shakespeare.folger.edu/shakespeares-works/titus-andronicus/
Created on Jul 31, 2015, from FDT version 9.9.2
Characters in the Play
#ERROR!
TITUS ANDRONICUS, a noble Roman general
LAVINIA, his daughter
His sons:
LUCIUS
MUTIUS
MARTIUS
QUINTUS
YOUNG LUCIUS, his grandson
MARCUS ANDRONICUS, Titus's brother, a Roman tribune
PUBLIUS, his son
Titus's kinsmen:
SEMPRONIUS
CAIUS





Your Mind, Girls

Barnard College · April 2025 — a live mixed-reality performance





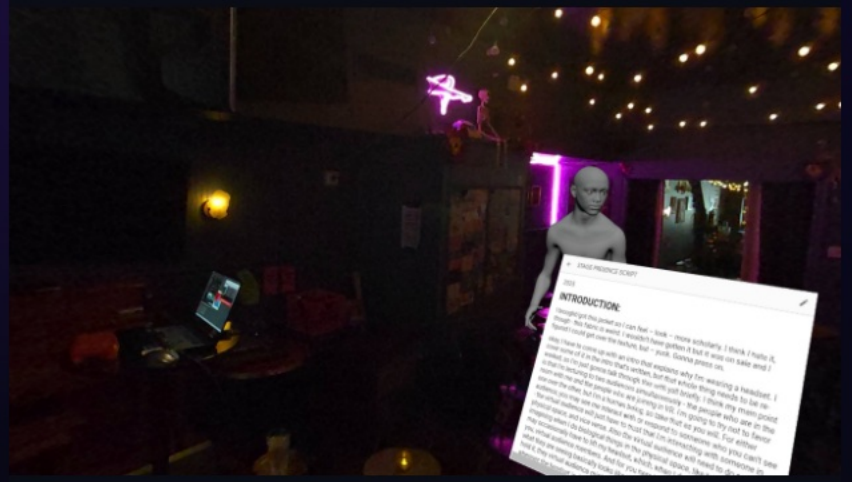












Stage Presence

XR as the Product

One story, more doors, each built on what only XR does

ONLY XR

- Presence
- A shared audience
- Your own viewpoint

ONE STORY

A Christmas Carol

Started as a book: Dickens, 1843

Live in VR

Actors perform live;
the audience stands inside

Carol, five seasons, 2021–2025

Flat livestream

The live show, streamed
to viewers on flat screens

Replay, together

The full live show replayed;
attendees join from headsets

Carol, this December · dates TBA

Real show live on stage

The stage production
in Louisville

Actors Theatre of Louisville, 2021

Festival circuit

Immersive sections at SXSW, Venice,
Cannes, Tribeca: a second audience

Carol: Raindance Immersive 2025 nominee

Done with Carol

ACT IV · 4 / 4

What Kind of Partnerships Are We Looking For?

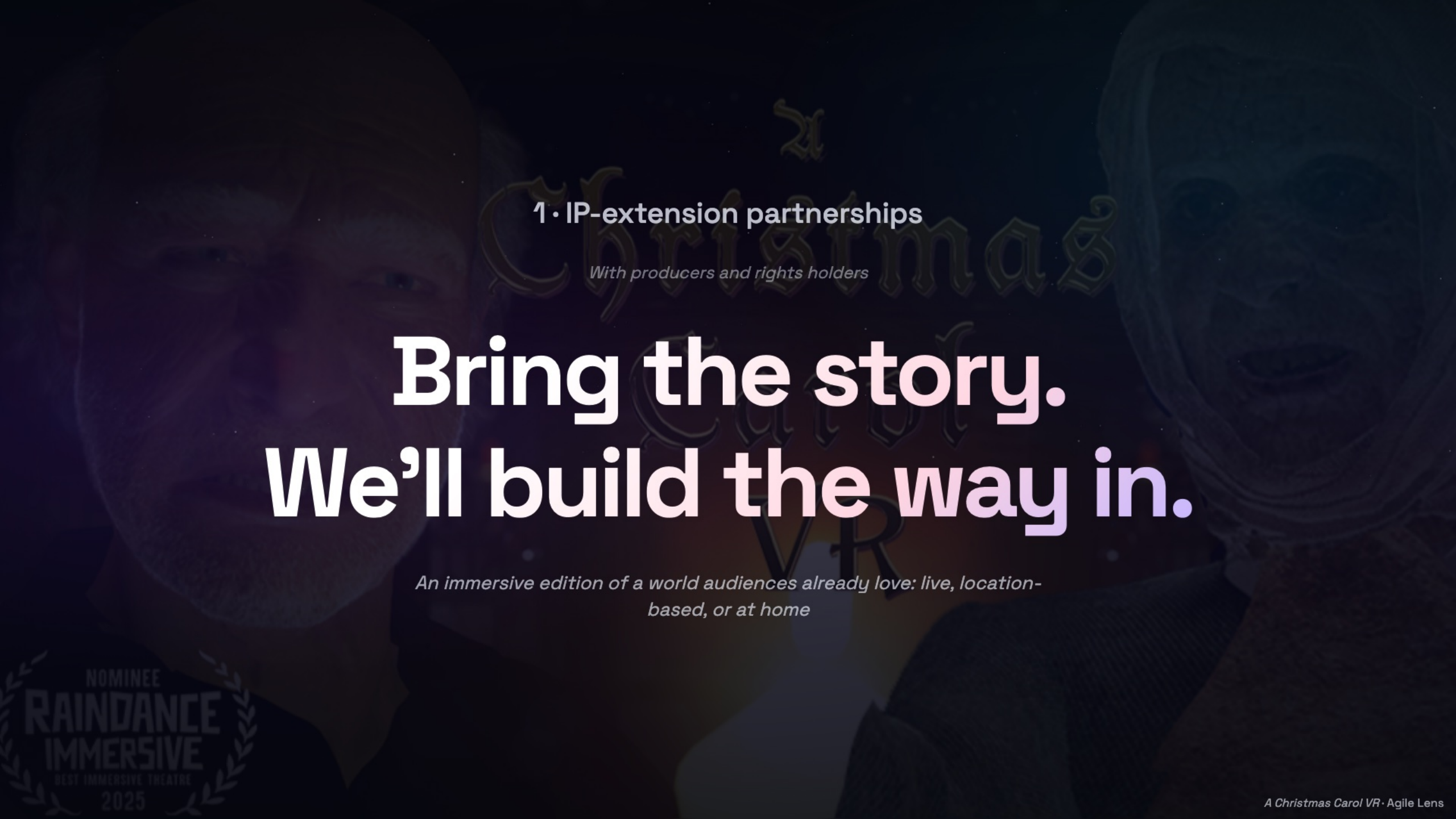
Two kinds. Both start with a story you already own or produce.

1 · IP-extension partnerships

With producers and rights holders

Bring the story. We'll build the way in.

An immersive edition of a world audiences already love: live, location-based, or at home





2 · Co-productions from day one

Immersive inside the financing and distribution plan

In the plan, not bolted on after.

Budgeted with the production: new windows, new audiences, assets that carry across formats

RSC rehearsal R&D · Agile Lens

How we start

One story.
One audience.
One prototype.

A short, paid prototype of a single audience moment, then a production plan you can finance

GRAZIE

Let’s Build the Way In.

IP-extension partnerships · Co-productions with immersive in the plan from day one

WEB agilelens.com

EMAIL info@agilelens.com · alex@agilelens.com · josette@agilelens.com

FIND US Demo area , Sala Trianon

Agile Lens

Say hello

Agile Lens